

YourLittlePal Final Project

By Vicky Huang and Annabelle Choi

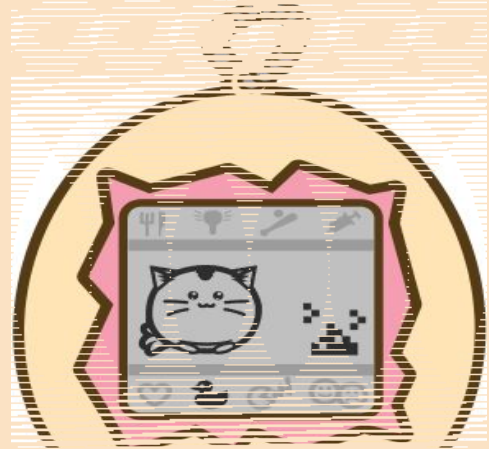
The problem

- *International students often feel lonely and stressed while far from home*
 - Research indicates that they experience higher rates of anxiety, depression and psychological distress
- *Dorms don't allow real pets, and they are too expensive to care for*
- *Students are too busy with classes to look after a living animal*
- *Moving a real pet home after graduation is very difficult and costly.*



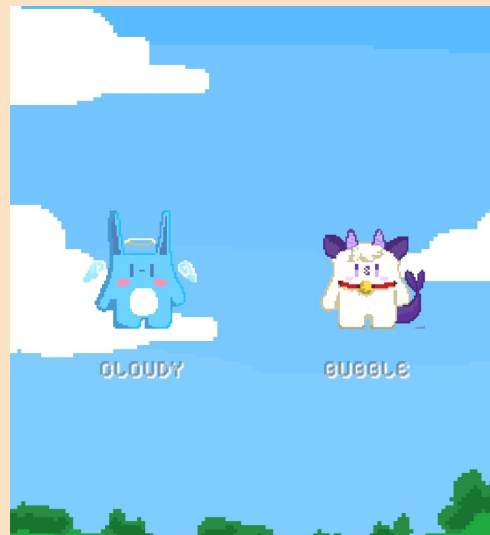
Our Solution

- *Digital pet provides consistent companionship and a sense of responsibility*
- *Low maintenance and no time constraints*
 - fits perfectly into a student's busy schedule
- *Less financial burden unlike taking care of a real pet*
 - Eg. vet bills, pet food and more...
- *Don't have to worry about shipping a pet after graduation*



Introducing Your Little Pal!

- *A little pixel-art pet that lives in your phone*
- *You can choose one of them as your friend*
 - *Cloudy*
 - *a rabbit with wings and a halo*
 - *Bubble*
 - *a half goat, half whale hybrid*



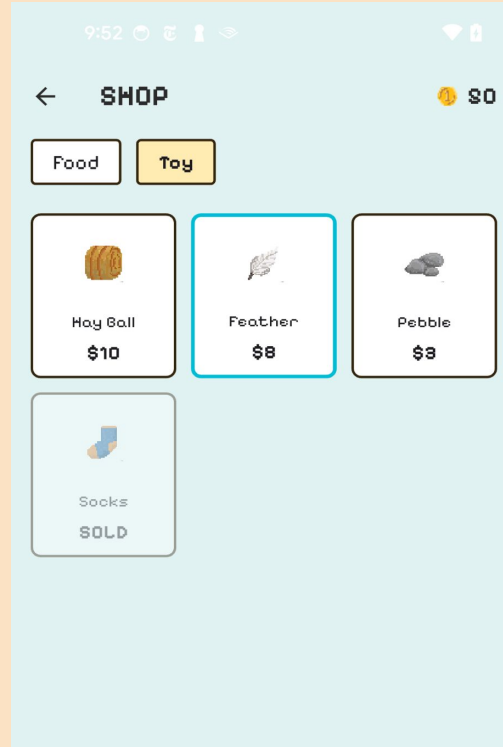
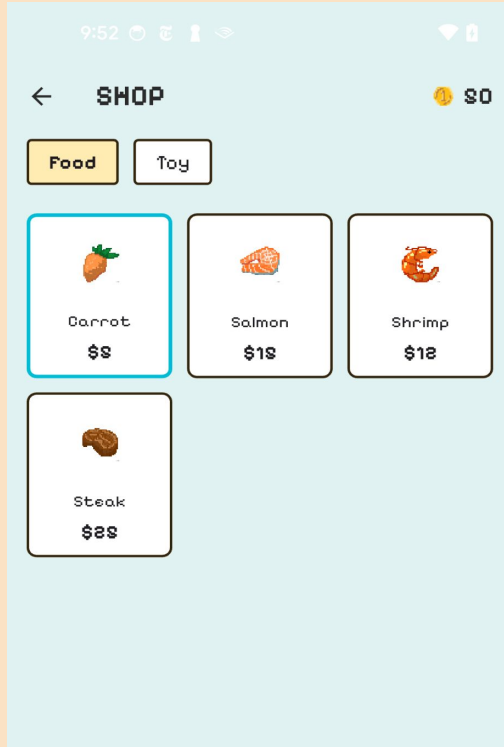
Features

- *Your pet has Health and Closeness that gently decreases over time*
- *What should you do?*
 - *Feed*
 - *Water*
 - *Wash*
 - *Play*
- *You will get coins by taking care of them*
- *You can also change their outfits!*



Features

- *With coins, you can buy food / toy for your pet*



Utility Evaluation

- *We evaluated the utility by do thorough tests to ensure:*
 - *pet care routine(feed, water, wash, play) works well*
 - *giving users clear set of daily tasks to do*
 - *Health and Closeness decreases over time*
 - *Giving users motivation to take care of their pet*
 - *Weather display shows correct information*
 - *Switching icons based on weather condition*
 - *Better if pet can have different dialogue based on weather condition*
 - *Area to improve:*
 - *No notification system to remind users to take care of the pet*
 - *Limited food, toy, outfits options*

Usability Evaluation

- *We evaluated the usability by inviting four participants to use our app:*
 - *They perform 3 core tasks and fill in a questionnaire*
 1. *Feeding the pet.*
 2. *Purchasing an item in the shop.*
 3. *Customizing the pet's outfit.*

Usability Results

Overall Score:
77.5 / 100

Usability:
3.5 / 5

Learnability:
3.8 / 5

users found it easy and enjoyable

*Users learned how to use the
app very quickly*



Accessibility Evaluation

- *We make sure that the app to be accessible by:*
 - *Adding Semantics labels*
 - *Making changes obvious*
 - *Supporting multiple languages*
 - *Allowing users to adjust screen brightness in the setting*
- *Area for further Improvement:*
 - *Larger text for the dialogue*
 - *Larger icons in shop*

Data Structure for models

- *We had three main files:*
 - *PetState*
 - *Stores all changes in the game*
 - *eg. Health, Closeness , inventories ...*
 - *Convent changes to and from JSON to save and load data*
 - *PetInfo*
 - *Stores facts about pets*
 - *read-only*
 - *Outfit*
 - *Stores asset ID of current outfit*
 - *When users changes clothing, old outfit is saved to PetState*

Topics Applied

- *State Management*
 - *Provider*
- *Data Persistence*
 - *SharedPreferences*
- *API*
 - *weather api*
- *Timers*
 - *use a Timer to calculate the hourly decrease*
Health and Closeness
- *And more...*

Challenges

- *Wash button onPan gesture detection*
 - *Couldn't sense users' finger movement*
 - *Fixed it by using widget's coordinate space*
- *Changing language in settings*
 - *Had no changes after switching language*
 - *Figured out that there is a problem with provider*
- *Challenges not overcome*
 - *We planned to have a font size slider in the setting page*
 - *But the font size won't change*

Thank you!

